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SECTION 1

Title of Talk:

**Bridging Data & Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in
Modern Business Intelligence**

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Introduction

On 20 May 2026, an industry talk entitled “Bridging Data & Decision: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business Intelligence” was held at BK1, N28, UTM. The session was delivered by Mr. Faiz Fablillah, a senior practitioner in data & AI governance and a certified data management professional of DAMA International.

The main goals of this talk are to introduce how modern organizations manage and govern data in order to transform raw data into meaningful insights for decision-making. It also highlighted the importance of data governance in ensuring the data quality, consistency and reliability before it can be used for business intelligence process.

This talk is highly relevant to Business Intelligence and Analytics because it connects theoretical concepts that we learned in class like dimensional modelling and ETL/ELT process with real-world industry applications. It also provides a clearer understanding of the role of analytical engineers in supporting data-driven decision making within organizations.

Key Takeaways

1. Analytics Engineer is responsible for transforming raw data and messy data to trusted and business ready information for decision making.

This role is not only building BI dashboards, but also understanding how the data is created, prepared, validated, documented and even governed before data is used for BI. Our speaker, Mr. Faiz, explained that many organizations use applications every day for operation and these systems keep producing the data as byproduct. However, the data behind system may be incomplete and duplicated. The analytics engineers are needed to help ensure that the data used in reports and dashboards is accurate and can be trusted by business users.

From our views, this made us realize that an analytics engineer is not just a technical man who prepared data or just creates dashboards only. The role also requires business understanding. Governance awareness and communication skills because the final goal is to help organization make better decisions using reliable data.

2. Analytics bridges the gap between raw data and business decisions by turning messy operational data into trusted insights that business users can rely on.

Mr. Faiz emphasized that BI dashboard may look impressive, but the question is “Can I trust this data?”. The analytics does not begin at dashboard stage, but it can be started earlier from understanding, cleaning, validating, documenting and governing the data. He also compared the

BI pipeline learned from the textbook with real situations in organizations. During the class, BI pipeline may look clean and structured where data flows from source system to ETL, data warehouse, and dashboard. However, in real world, the organization will often face messy data, missing documentation, inconsistent definitions and other problems. This shows that before a dashboard can support decision making, data must be prepared and trusted through compliance management.

This is also one of the most important lessons from the talk because it changes our view of Business Intelligence. We always think BI mainly focuses on dashboards and data visualizations but now understand the real value of BI depend on data quality and trustworthiness of the data behind the dashboard.

3. Data Governance, data management, data quality, metadata, data lineage, data catalog, security, master data management, data architecture, data integration, AI assisted data quality and agentic data management which are the main practices shared by Mr. Faiz.

He explained the data governance gives directions while data management executes the work. Governance defines the rules, policies, responsibilities and decisions about how data should be managed while data management carries out the actual work such as quality checking, documentation and monitoring. He also highlighted importance of data quality dimensions such as accuracy, completeness, consistency, timeliness, validity and uniqueness. For example, a primary key support uniqueness by preventing duplicate records. Metadata, he asked Elijah to answer why it is so important? It is important because it describes the meaning, ownership, structure and usage of data. Without metadata, users may not know where data comes from, how it should be used, or what the columns mean.

4. One real-world example shared was that many companies use application systems daily, but the data produced from those systems may not be ready for BI immediately.

Users may only focus on completing tasks while the organization still needs to manage the data created behind the system. If data is incomplete or poorly documented, the dashboard built from those data will not be trustworthy. He also mentioned the need for compliance before creating a BI dashboard development. The reason is which dashboard exposes data to different users, so organizations must know who can view which data and under what conditions. For example, a CEO may be allowed to view organization-level performance while normal staff must not. This show BI development is also related to privacy, access control and responsible data usage.

Reflection and Critical Insights

The industry talk provided valuable insights about the importance of data governance in modern organizations. A valuable insight discovered was that data governance transforms raw data into trustworthy decision-making. Without good data governance, the insights generated are less reliable and can affect business performance negatively.

Another key point from the talk was the main pillars that help to build trustworthy insight. The main pillars including data quality, metadata, data lineage, security, and cataloging. These elements showed that business intelligence depends on how well the data is managed and maintained.

Moreover, the talk also related to the topics that were learned in the Business Intelligence course. It helped to strengthen the idea that analytics is only useful when data is accurate and properly governed. In the current business ecosystem, analytics engineering is important because it helps to transform raw data into clear and useful information for reporting and decision-making.

An inspiring point from the talk was the future use of artificial intelligence (AI) in data governance, where AI can help to automate tasks such as checking data quality and detecting inconsistencies in data. Overall, the session was very informative and improved the understanding of how data governance is related to analytics engineering, and modern business intelligence.

Conclusion

Overall, this industry talk gave us a clearer understanding of the importance of data governance and data management in business intelligence. Before attending this talk, most of us thought business intelligence was mainly about building dashboards and visualizations. However, after listening to Mr. Faiz's sharing, we realized that the quality and credibility of the data behind the dashboards are actually more crucial.

This talk also helps us better understand the role of analytical engineers in organizations. Analytics engineers are not only responsible for preparing data but also for ensuring that the data is accurate, well-documented and suitable for decision-making. This has changed our view of the career path related to business intelligence and data analysis, especially in the field of analytics engineering and data governance.

From an academic perspective, this talk helps us link the theories learned in the classroom like ETL/ELT process with real industry practices. Understanding in the talk gives us better understanding of how these concepts are applied real organization and will guide our future analytics project and courses.